PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mitsubishi Pajero / Montero (Second Generation)

1991–1999 · V20 · V40 · V55W Evolution · Montero

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Ask for the timing-belt receipt**
  On the V6s and the 4D56 the belt is a scheduled part, and owners say the 3.5 doesn't survive a snapped belt. Australian owners use about 100,000 km. With no proof, price in a belt, tensioner, idlers and water pump. The 4M40 uses a chain.

- [ ] **Look hard at the V6 cooling system**
  Check for milky oil, coolant loss and a temperature gauge that wanders. ExplorOz mechanics describe the V6 Pajeros as prone to head gaskets and say the heads crack. A combustion-leak test before purchase costs very little.

- [ ] **Blue smoke on the overrun**
  Worn valve stem seals are a known V6 complaint. One Australian owner says they 'normally need replacing at 200,000 km', and Montana Montero has a video on why Monteros burn oil. Watch the exhaust after a long idle and on the first blip of the throttle.

- [ ] **Exercise the Super Select lever**
  On loose ground, go through 2H, 4H, 4HLc and 4LLc. The lights should stop flashing once each mode engages. A light that keeps flashing, or a front axle that won't engage, points to the vacuum system. Owners say the system misbehaves on trucks that rarely use 4WD.

- [ ] **Check the steering linkage**
  Mitsubishi's pitman-arm notice covers every second-generation code, the Evolution included. Feel for play at the pitman and idler arms and inspect every boot. A cracked boot means the joint needs replacing.

- [ ] **Measure the front ride height**
  Tired torsion bars leave the nose low, and a bull bar makes it worse. Uneven ride height side to side or a nose-down stance means the bars need adjusting or replacing.

- [ ] **Rust in the sills and chassis**
  Steven Taylor's Mk2 Pajero video shows sill replacement and chassis welding on a 2.8. BaT's 1998 Montero needed its underside treated. Probe the sills, the rear chassis rails and the spring mounts.

- [ ] **Run the VIN for recalls**
  US recalls include the 1998–2000 NADI driver airbag (20V035000), cracking front brake hoses on 1992–94 trucks (96V143), chafing brake lines on 1997–98 trucks (98V220) and a loose crank-pulley bolt on 1992–96 3.0s (00V311001). In Australia, NL airbag trucks are being bought back.

YEARS TO KNOW

1998	BEWARE	Export and Gulf trucks get the 'blister' wide-fender facelift; airbags standard on 3.5 models in those markets. Beware the NADI driver airbag: 1998–2000 US Monteros are

under recall 20V035000 for a new inflator, and in Australia Mitsubishi is buying back NL Pajeros built 31 May 1996 to 30 September 2000 because no replacement exists

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **NADI driver airbag inflator**
  1998–2000 · NHTSA 20V035000
- ☐ **Crankshaft pulley bolt can loosen (3.0)**
  1992–1996 · NHTSA 00V311001
- ☐ **Front wheel-side brake hoses can crack**
  1992–1994 · NHTSA 96V143001
- ☐ **Front lower brake hoses can crack**
  1994 · NHTSA 00V226001
- ☐ **Front brake lines chafe through**
  1997–1998 · NHTSA 98V220000
- ☐ **Accessory cargo mat stops third-row seats latching**
  1994–1998 · NHTSA 98V205000
- ☐ **Airbag warning labels too small**
  1998–2000 · NHTSA 04V428000
- ☐ **Aftermarket Reese trailer hitch weld (equipment)**
  1991–1992 · NHTSA 93E023000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Chassis codes**
  Mitsubishi's own notice lists the second-generation codes: V14V, V21W, V23C, V23W, V24C, V24V, V24W, V25C, V25W, V26C, V26W, V34V, V43W, V44W, V45W, V46V, V46W and V55W. JDMBUYSELL advises confirming the complete code on the frame or VIN plate.
- ☐ **A real Evolution**
  Check the plate for E-V55W, a 3,496 cc 6G74 MIVEC V6 rated at 280 PS, a three-door body and independent multi-link/double-wishbone rear suspension. Overfenders, twin rear fins and a bonnet scoop are easy to copy; the rear suspension isn't.
- ☐ **DOHC or SOHC 3.5**
  Australian owners say NJ and NK trucks used the DOHC 3.5 and the NL a SOHC 3.5. In the US, the 1994 SR is rated at 215 hp (DOHC) and a 1998 Montero at 200 hp.
- ☐ **Locker and Super Select**
  A factory rear locker shows up as a dash switch and air lines to the rear diff, and works only in 4HLc or 4LLc. Every second-generation truck has the Super Select gated lever; US trucks are badged Active-Trac.
- ☐ **Grey-import tells**
  Australian owners say mirrors on the front mudguards and higher-spec interiors mark a Japanese import. In the US, right-hand drive and a km/h speedometer give it away.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/pajero/pajero-gen2/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks